



Advanced Water Safety

Parent & Carer Information

Your son or daughter is completing the Advanced Water Safety unit in Health & Physical Education. This sheet tells you what they're learning, how they'll be assessed, and how you can support them at home.

Year 9–10 HPE

Victorian Curriculum 2.0

VC2HP10PO2–VC2HP10PO9 · VC2HP10MO1

SCHOOL

TEACHER

TERM / YEAR



What Is Your Child Learning?

The Advanced Water Safety unit builds on the Year 7–8 program. At this level, students move beyond learning the rules to **analysing why water safety problems exist and what can be done about them**. This develops critical thinking, research skills, and health literacy.

- **Victorian & global drowning data** — students learn to calculate and interpret drowning rate statistics using real Victorian Government data
- **Physiology of drowning** — how drowning affects the body, why CPR within 4 minutes is critical, cold water shock, and secondary drowning
- **Social determinants of drowning risk** — why some groups (males, CALD communities, rural communities) are at higher risk, and how structural factors drive this
- **Prevention strategy evaluation** — assessing what actually works to prevent drowning, and why, with reference to evidence
- **International comparison** — comparing Australian water safety approaches to those used in the UK and USA

Why does this matter at Year 9–10? Young people aged 15–24 are one of Victoria's highest-risk groups for drowning. The knowledge and decision-making skills developed in this unit are directly relevant to the situations your child will face in the years ahead — at beaches, rivers, pools, and social gatherings near water.

How Will My Child Be Assessed?

Students complete a **summative assessment task** that asks them to apply their unit knowledge in a real-world communication format. They choose one of three options:

Option A — Policy Brief

600–800 words addressed to the Victorian Minister for Sport, with two evidence-based recommendations and measurable success metrics.

Option B — Awareness Campaign

A designed campaign targeting one high-risk group, with a 100-word justification of design choices and evidence base.

Option C — School Audit ★

An audit of the school's water safety provision benchmarked against Victorian Curriculum requirements, with recommendations.

A rubric is provided to students at the start of the unit so they know exactly what is expected. It assesses six criteria — data analysis, physiological knowledge, social determinants analysis, prevention strategy evaluation, international comparison, and communication product quality.

How Can I Support My Child at Home?

You don't need to be a water safety expert to support this unit. The most valuable thing you can do is **have conversations about water safety** — it reinforces what they're learning and makes it personally relevant.

Try asking:

 "What did you find most surprising about the Victorian drowning data?"

 "Why do you think young men are more likely to drown than young women?"

 "What would you do if you saw someone drowning at the beach?"

 "What makes a river or dam more dangerous than a patrolled beach?"

 "If you had \$5 million to reduce drowning in Victoria, what would you do?"

 "What's the difference between how Australia and the UK teach water safety?"

- **For the assessment task:** encourage your child to start early, visit the recommended websites listed in their workbook, and read their draft before submitting
- **If they seem stuck:** ask them to explain their argument out loud — often talking it through helps clarify thinking
- **Research support:** key websites are lsv.com.au, royallifesaving.com.au, and who.int — all free and publicly accessible

"My child can swim well — why do they still need this unit?"

This is a common and understandable question. The answer is that the vast majority of Victorian drowning victims could swim. **Drowning is rarely caused by inability to swim** — it's caused by:

- Swimming in conditions beyond one's ability (rip currents, cold water)
- Swimming at unpatrolled locations without supervision
- Alcohol and risk-taking behaviour near water
- Not knowing how to respond in an emergency
- Structural barriers — communities that grew up without swim access

This unit develops the **critical thinking and decision-making skills** that swimming ability alone cannot provide — and that directly affect survival outcomes.

Key Resources & Contacts



Life Saving Victoria

lsv.com.au

AU

Royal Life Saving
Australia

royallifesaving.com.au



BeachSafe App

beachsafe.org.au



St John Ambulance

stjohnvic.com.au



WHO Drowning Data

who.int



Victorian Curriculum

vcaa.vic.edu.au

& Please return this section to your child's teacher by: _____

STUDENT NAME

PARENT / CARER NAME

SIGNATURE & DATE

- ☐ I have read this information sheet and discussed it with my child.
- ☐ I have questions about this unit — please contact me. My contact:

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Version 2.0

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